Swimart
Pool care made easy!
Bli Bli

Stains on your pool?

Most pool stains come from one of two places: metals in the water, or leaves and algae sitting on the surface. Work out which one you have, then treat it the right way.

Test it first, then treat it.

What kind of stain is it?

Colour and location give you a good first guess. The home test on the next page confirms it.



Organic

Looks like	Brown, tan or green-brown patches, sometimes leaf-shaped. Berries can leave pink or purple marks.
Found	Under leaves, gumnuts and berries, on steps and the floor.
Why	Leaves and algae left sitting in the pool release tannins that dye the surface.

Clue: chlorine lightens it.



Iron and manganese

Looks like	Rust brown, orange or reddish-brown. Manganese shows as purple to black.
Found	A brown haze across the surface, or rust spots.
Why	Bore or tank water, rusting fittings or steel in the concrete, and low pH eating away at metal parts.

Clue: vitamin C lightens it.



Copper

Looks like	Blue-green, teal, grey or black. Often blotchy on pebble finishes.
Found	On the floor and near the return jets.
Why	Copper ionisers such as Naked pools running too high, pH drifting up, or copper-based algaecides. Low pH can also eat copper parts in older heaters.

Clue: vitamin C lightens it.

Calcium scale

Looks like	White or grey crust that feels rough to touch.
Found	Along the waterline tiles, on pebble and around water features.
Why	High calcium hardness and pH, made worse by evaporation and heat.

Clue: neither test shifts it. It's a deposit, not a stain.

The two-minute stain test

You'll need a vitamin C tablet, an old sock and a spoonful of granular chlorine.

1

Rub vitamin C on it

Hold a vitamin C tablet on the stain for 30 seconds.

It lightens: a metal stain, most likely iron or copper.

2

Try chlorine

Put a spoonful of granular chlorine in a sock and hold it on the stain for 30 seconds.

It lightens: an organic stain.

3

Neither works

It may be calcium scale, a mix of stains, or a surface problem.

Next: bring us a photo and we'll take a look.

Skip the chlorine test on vinyl liners and coloured or patterned finishes, as it can bleach them.

Before you treat, bring us a water sample

We'll test pH, alkalinity, calcium, chlorine, iron and copper, look at your photo, and match the right product and dose to your pool. Stain removers are strong acids, so getting the dose right matters.

Our stain range

We use the Lo-Chlor range in store and on our service runs. Here's which product suits which stain.

Product	Organic	Iron	Copper	Scale
Iron Stain Remover	–	**Yes**	–	–
Salt Stain Remover	–	**Yes**	**Light stains**	–
Multi Stain Remover	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
CU Later Part I & II	–	–	**Heavy stains**	–
Stain & Scale Defence	–	**Prevents**	**Prevents**	**Yes**

For brown iron stains

Iron Stain Remover

A high-strength acid blend for rust-brown iron staining.

- Chlorine below 0.5 ppm, pH 7.2–7.6
- 1 kg per 50,000 L, pump running
- Run the pump 24 hours, then rebalance

For iron, manganese and lighter copper stains

Salt Stain Remover

Citric acid based. Gentle enough for all surfaces, and our go-to for lighter copper stains too.

- Chlorine removed, pH 7.2–7.6
- 1 kg per 50,000 L, sprinkled around the edge
- Usually clears within 12 hours. Repeat once if needed

When you're not sure, or it's a mix

Multi Stain Remover

Treats metal stains as well as organic ones such as leaf, algae and mould marks.

- Chlorine as close to zero as possible
- 1 kg per 50,000 L, as a spot or whole-pool treatment
- Raise pH slowly afterwards, or the stain can come back

For heavy copper staining

CU Later Part I & II

A two-part treatment. Part I is an oxidiser that primes the stain, and Part II is an acid blend that lifts it.

- Chlorine below 1 ppm, pH 7.0
- Part I: 1 kg per 50,000 L over the stain, pump running
- Part II: 1 kg per 50,000 L, 5 minutes after the water changes colour
- Run the pump 24 hours, then rebalance

Part II is a strong acid and drops pH and alkalinity a long way.

Prevention and calcium scale

Stain & Scale Defence

A maintenance treatment that keeps metals and calcium from settling on surfaces, equipment and heaters. Use it after any stain treatment to stop the stain coming back, and monthly to keep scale away.

- Start-up dose: 5 L per 50,000 L, spread over as much of the pool as you can
- Monthly: 1 L per 50,000 L
- If calcium hardness is above 500 ppm, we'll bring that down first

Dose for your pool size

Pool size	Stain remover	Defence start	Monthly
10,000 L	200 g	1 L	200 mL
20,000 L	400 g	2 L	400 mL
30,000 L	600 g	3 L	600 mL
40,000 L	800 g	4 L	800 mL
50,000 L	1 kg	5 L	1 L

Doses are scaled from the labels. Always read the label on the pack, and check your dose with us before you treat.

Treating a metal stain

1 Confirm the stain and test the water

Bring us a photo and a water sample. We'll confirm the stain type, check the balance, and give you the product and dose for your pool.

2 Switch off a copper ioniser

If you have a Naked pool or another copper ioniser, switch it off before you start and leave it off until the water is rebalanced.

3 Let the chlorine drop

Turn off the salt chlorinator a day or two before treating. Chlorine needs to be below 0.5 ppm for most products, as chlorine fights the stain remover.

Short on time? We can supply a chlorine reducer.

4 Set the pH

Bring the pH to 7.2–7.6, or down to 7.0 for CU Later.

5 Add the stain remover with the pump running

Sprinkle it over the stain or evenly around the pool. On Quartzon, coloured pebble, coloured marble, exposed aggregate or printed vinyl, dissolve it in a bucket of pool water first so it never sits on the surface.

6 Run the pump for 24 hours

Keep swimmers out while the treatment works. Brush any stubborn spots to help it along.

7 Rebalance slowly

Stain removers drop pH and alkalinity. Raise them a little at a time with buffer, as raising them too fast can cloud the water and put the stain straight back.

8 Add Stain & Scale Defence

Once the water is balanced, add the start-up dose to hold remaining metals in the water so they don't settle again.

9 Restart your system

Turn the chlorinator back on. If you have a copper ioniser, restart it at a lower output than before and bring us a sample after a week so we can check the copper level.

Handle stain removers safely

- Wear gloves and eye protection.
- Never mix stain removers with chlorine or other chemicals, and add each one to the pool separately.
- Store them in their original containers, out of reach of children.
- Keep swimmers out until the treatment has run and the water is rebalanced.

Treating an organic stain

1. Scoop out leaves and debris, and empty the baskets.
2. Brush the stain hard.
3. Raise the chlorine with a shock dose at dusk.
4. Hold granular chlorine in a sock on stubborn marks, except on vinyl or coloured finishes.
5. Still there after a few days? Try Multi Stain Remover.

Copper and Naked pools

Copper ionisers release a small, controlled amount of copper to keep algae away. When the output is set too high, or pH and alkalinity creep up, that copper drops out of the water and settles on the surface as blue-green, grey or black stains.

- Keep pH at the lower end, 7.2–7.4.
- Run the ioniser at the lowest output that keeps the pool clear.
- Don't add copper-based algaecides.
- Bring in a sample monthly so we can check the copper level.

Stop stains coming back

Keep pH between 7.2 and 7.6
High pH drops metals out of the water. Low pH eats metal parts and puts metals into it.

Use Stain & Scale Defence monthly
It holds metals and calcium in the water so they don't settle.

Test bore and tank water
Top-up water from a bore or tank can carry iron and manganese. We'll test it for you.

Don't let leaves sit
Scoop leaves and berries out promptly, and use a cover if trees overhang the pool.

Watch your copper ioniser
Lower the output if copper reads high, and avoid copper algaecides.

Call us about rust spots that keep returning
A rust spot that comes back in the same place can mean steel in the concrete is showing through.

Need a hand?

Swimart
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(07) 5356 9448

Call the team at Swimart Bli Bli or drop in with a photo and a water sample. Call us too if a stain is still there after a second treatment, black stains appear, or the water turns cloudy after treating.

Visit us
1/311 David Low Way, Bli Bli QLD 4560

Shop hours
Mon–Fri 9:00 am – 4:30 pm · Sat 8:30 am – 12:30 pm